

RTFCLMGZN

Deployment & Operations Guide

How to put your site online, keep it running, change it,
and switch AI engines — explained simply.

Read this tonight. Keep it for launch day.

Prepared for the founder • an evergreen reference

SECTION 1

The one big idea: your project is TWO things

Before anything else, understand this. If you get this, everything else is easy. Your project is not one thing — it's two separate things that live in two different places and do two different jobs.

THE WEBSITE	THE NEWSROOM
The pages readers see. Just files that display whatever content exists. Lives ON Cloudflare.	The AI agents that WRITE the articles into the files. Runs somewhere ELSE (your computer today).

A simple analogy: think of a restaurant. **The Website is the dining room** — where guests sit and are served. **The Newsroom is the kitchen** — where the food is actually made. Cloudflare hosts your dining room. The kitchen is somewhere in the back, cooking. Guests never see the kitchen; they just enjoy what comes out.

Why this matters

Every question you have — how to deploy, how to make changes, what happens when you switch AI engines — has a different answer for the Website vs. the Newsroom. Keep the two separate in your head and none of it is confusing.

SECTION 2

Putting the Website online (Cloudflare)

This is the easy part, and the good news: your domain **rtfclmgzn.com** is **already on Cloudflare**, so pointing it at your site is just a couple of clicks. You have two ways to upload the Website:

Option A — Drag and drop (simplest, good for a first look)

In the Cloudflare dashboard: Pages -> Create -> Direct Upload, then drop in your web folder. Live in about two minutes. The catch: every future update means dragging the folder in again by hand.

Option B — Connect to GitHub (the real way, recommended)

Put the project in a GitHub repository (a free online folder for code), and connect Cloudflare Pages to it. Now, every time you save changes and "push" them, Cloudflare automatically rebuilds and republishes your site in about one minute. No manual re-uploading, ever.

The setting to remember

Your site is "static" (plain files, no build step). So in Cloudflare's setup: **Build command: leave empty. Output folder: web.** That's it.

Recommendation: Use Option B. The one-time setup (30–45 minutes) pays for itself instantly, because it makes every future change — and every new article — publish automatically.

SECTION 3

Making changes after it's live

This is the question you really asked, and here's the clean answer. Once you're set up with GitHub + Cloudflare (Option B), **every** change — whether it's a new feature we build together, or a new article the newsroom writes — follows the exact same three-step loop:

1	Edit the files On your computer — with an AI assistant, or the newsroom pipeline does it automatically.
2	Push One command (or one click) sends the changes to GitHub.
3	Cloudflare auto-publishes It notices the change and updates the live site in about a minute. You do nothing.

So the answer to "do I make changes locally and then redeploy?" is: **you make the change (locally), push it, and it redeploys itself.** You never manually re-upload the whole site. And a new article is just a changed file, so it rides the exact same loop as a design change.

The one small addition needed

Today the newsroom pipeline just edits the files on your computer. For articles to auto-publish, it needs one extra habit added to its instructions: after writing, "push" the changes. That's a single line added to the pipeline — a quick job whenever you deploy.

SECTION 4

"Keep it running" — the honest part

Here's the one piece people miss, so read this carefully. Once the Website is on Cloudflare, it stays online 24/7 forever, all on its own — Cloudflare handles that. **But the Newsroom (the kitchen) is a different story.**

Right now, the AI that writes your daily articles runs **on your computer**, through the Claude app. That means: for new articles to be written on schedule, your computer needs to be on and the app open at those times. If your laptop is closed, the kitchen isn't cooking — though the dining room (your live site) stays open and serving everything already made.

There are two stages, and it's perfectly fine to start at Stage 1:

- **Stage 1 (start here):** Website on Cloudflare (always on). Newsroom runs on your machine when it's on. Simple, free, works today.
- **Stage 2 (later):** Move the Newsroom to a "cloud runner" — a scheduled job in the cloud that writes and publishes articles on its own, even while your computer is off. This is the true hands-off version, and it's a separate project from hosting the Website.

Bottom line

You can deploy the Website tonight and it will run forever. Fully automatic, laptop-can-be-closed article generation is a later upgrade — not a requirement to launch.

SECTION 5

Switching the AI engine (to ChatGPT / GPT-5.6)

This is the part that should give you relief. **Cloudflare, your website, your domain, and the whole publish loop do not care which AI writes the content.** They are completely separate decisions.

Switching engines only changes the **Newsroom** (the kitchen) — which AI "brain" reads your agent instructions and writes the articles. It does **not** touch any of this:

Stays exactly the same when you switch engines

- Cloudflare hosting — it just serves files; it has no idea what an AI is
- Your website's code, design, and all existing articles
- Your domain, rtfcimgzn.com
- The publish loop (edit -> push -> Cloudflare updates)
- Image generation (already runs on Google's Gemini, not Claude)

Whether Claude or GPT-5.6 writes tomorrow's article, both produce the **same kind of file**, push it to the **same place**, and Cloudflare serves it **identically**. The only thing that changes in your day-to-day is **which assistant you sit in front of to edit code** — like switching which word processor you type in. The project itself doesn't notice.

The takeaway that frees you

Deploying now costs you nothing on the engine decision, because hosting and the AI brain are independent. You can host tonight and still switch engines next month without changing a single thing about your live website.

SECTION 6

What's real vs. still "pretend" after you deploy

So you set expectations correctly on launch night, here's the honest split of what works fully vs. what is still a prototype placeholder until a later step.

FULLY REAL

- Reading every article, guide, resource
- The magazine & The Primer
- Search, archive, RSS
- Bookmarks & read-later (saved in your browser)
- The transparency / cost page

STILL SIMULATED (needs a "backend" later)

- Real accounts & login across devices
- Payments / subscriptions (Stripe)
- Real reaction & comment counts
- The daily email list

Good news: Cloudflare itself offers the "backend" tools (called Workers and D1) to make the right-hand column real when you're ready — so it's a natural next layer on the same platform, not a rebuild.

SECTION 7

Quick glossary & launch-night checklist

Plain-English glossary

Cloudflare Pages	The free service that hosts (shows to the world) your website files.
Static site	A website made of plain files that just display content. Fast, cheap, simple. Yours is one.
GitHub / repository	A free online folder that stores your project and its history. Cloudflare watches it for changes.
Push	Sending your saved changes up to GitHub. This is what triggers the auto-publish.
Deploy / redeploy	Publishing the site (or the updated site) to the live web.
Backend	Server-side machinery needed for real accounts, payments, and saved data. You don't have one yet.
The engine / brain	The AI model that writes the articles (Claude today; possibly GPT-5.6 later).

Launch-night checklist

- [] Decide the engine first if you want to (or don't — it doesn't block hosting).
- [] Create a free GitHub account and put the project in a repository.
- [] In Cloudflare: Pages -> connect the GitHub repo. Build command empty, output folder web.
- [] Attach your domain `rtfclmgzn.com` to the Pages project (a couple of clicks — DNS is already yours).
- [] Visit `rtfclmgzn.com` — you're live.
- [] Add the one-line "push after publishing" step to the newsroom so new articles auto-publish.
- [] Later, when ready: real accounts + payments (Cloudflare Workers/D1), then move the newsroom fully to the cloud.

RTFCLMGZN — artificial magazine. This guide is a plain-English reference; the assistant can do the actual setup with you when you're ready.